

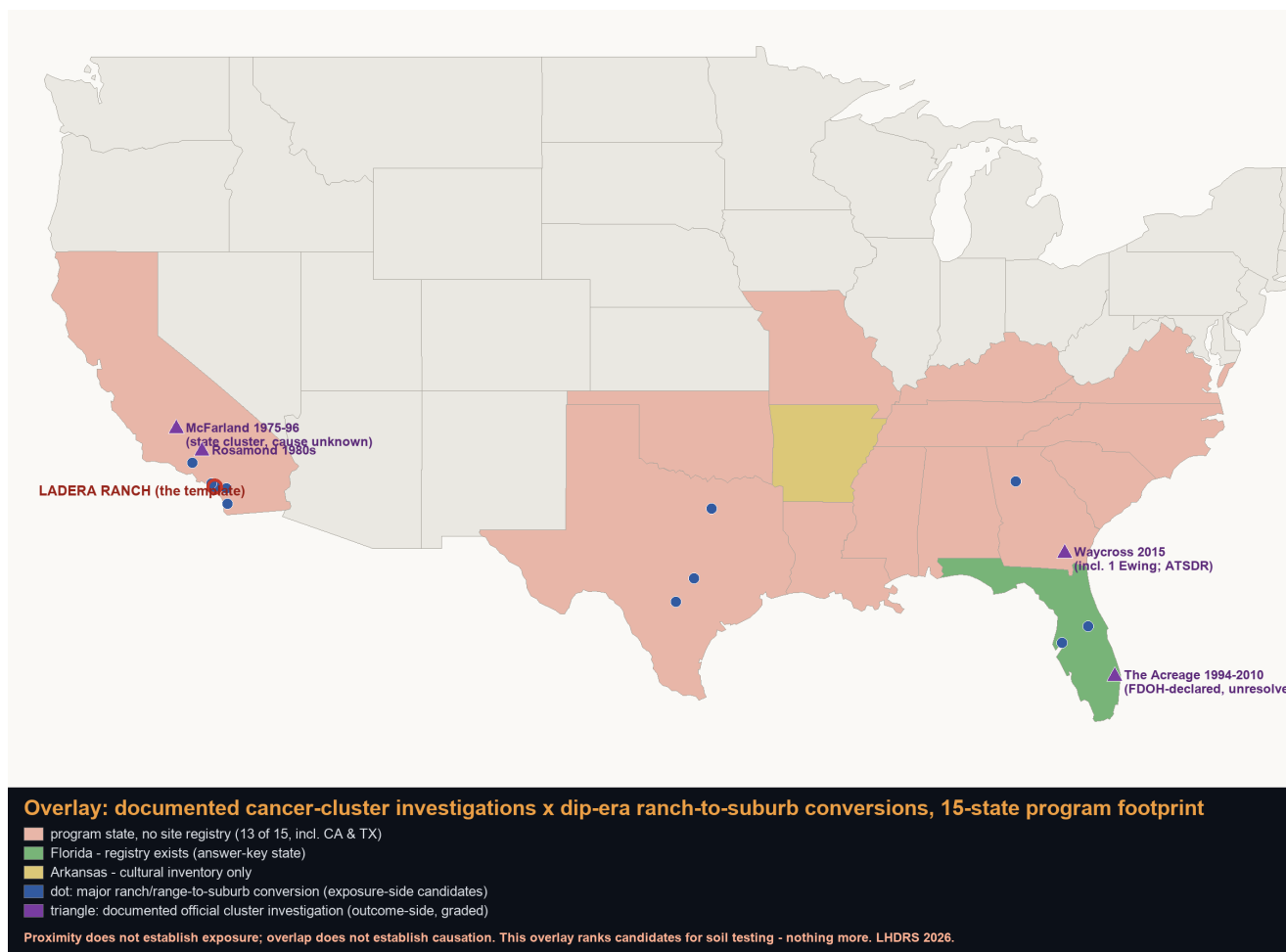
Fifteen states dipped cattle in arsenic. One wrote down where.

National findings — the 1906–1943 federal tick-eradication program's arsenic legacy, cross-referenced against modern development and documented cancer-cluster investigations. Compiled 11 August 2026 · Andy Stavros / LEHRP · v1.1

This is an independent research and data-organization project. It does not provide medical advice and does not establish that any historic land use or party caused any illness. Proximity does not establish exposure; temporal overlap does not establish causation. No dip-site soil has been tested in California; no contamination is asserted for any community named. Every claim carries a source grade (A1 official primary → D speculation). The sole purpose of this compilation is to rank candidates for soil testing.

1 · The national picture

- The USDA Bureau of Animal Industry's Cattle Fever Tick Eradication Program (1906–1943) spanned **fifteen states** — the quarantined South plus the 13 southern counties of California — and required dipping cattle in arsenical solution **every fourteen days**. [A1/A2]
- The Bureau's FY1910 ledger: **California released 32,271 square miles that year — the largest release in the nation** (Texas second at 10,675; national total 57,520). California completed statewide release March 1912 — the fastest exit of any major program state. Shortest program, biggest subsequent build-out, zero site records. [A1 — BAI Annual Report, held]
- Registry scorecard: **Florida is the only state that inventoried its sites** (~3,400 vats; 1994 assessment legislation). Arkansas holds a cultural (not contamination) inventory. Thirteen states — including California and Texas — recorded nothing. [A2/B1]
- Scale of the unknown (model estimate): program structure implies tens of thousands of vats nationally; >90% have no recorded location today. NSW Australia's registered system still ended with ~2% of known sites under homes — implying hundreds of potential built-over or development-adjacent sites in the U.S. This is an order-of-magnitude inference, not a count.



Blue dots: ranch-to-suburb conversions (exposure side). Purple triangles: documented cluster investigations (outcome side). Layers assembled independently, exposure first.

2 · The Florida answer key — the state that kept records

- **When Florida tested its vat sites, 11 of 12 exceeded acceptable soil concentrations (92%),** one with an extensive groundwater plume (Walker Ranch). Remediation: \$40,000–\$450,000 per site. [A2 — FDEP/Woodward-Clyde assessment report, 58 pp., held with hash]
- Florida's cleanup ledger already documents the failure mode: vats at **Stoneybrook Development** (Orange Co.), **Peach Creek Development** (Walton Co.), and an **elementary school** (Clay Co.). The state also records disused vats reused as “swimming holes for children.” [A2]
- The state report specifies the identical federal formula — 24 lb sodium carbonate + **8 lb arsenic trioxide** + 1 gal pine tar — independently cross-validating the LEHRP mass-balance inputs. Post-1940 mixes added DDT/HCH. [A2]
- **Palm Beach County dipped longest:** among the last regulated counties; the state's final fever-tick outbreak (1960) was on Palm Beach cattle; the program ran to October 1961. The Acreage cluster (below) sits in this county. Open question: the 45-site cleanup ledger shows one Palm Beach vat (Jupiter, ~20 km away); the full ~3,400-site inventory is the subject of records request G11 (drafted). A null will be published as prominently as a match.

3 · The Australian control case

New South Wales registered its 1,648 dip sites: soil arsenic to 14,000 mg/kg (CA background 1–11); 254 vats demolished; **29 with residences built directly over them** — demolition removes the concrete, not the arsenic. Houses and schools sit on or near former dip sites. [B1/A2; 254/29 breakdown B2 pending primary-source trace]

4 · Documented cluster investigations × the program footprint

Place	Years	What	Status	Soil-disturbance context
Ladera Ranch CA	2013–24	pediatric incl. 6 Ewing reports [C]	no official determination; LEHRP research; soil testing organizing	mass grading 1997–2007 on O'Neill Ranch (heavy-tier county) [A1]
McFarland CA (Kern)	1975–96	~21 childhood cancers ~3× [A2]	state cluster; cause never found	continuous ag disturbance; inside 13-county quarantine
The Acreage FL	1994–2010	girls' brain tumors 5.5× [A2]	FDOH-DECLARED; closed unresolved	rapid build-out on former citrus/range; longest-dipping county
Waycross GA	2015	3 rhabdo + 1 Ewing in 60 days [A2/B2]	below cluster threshold; ATSDR assessed rail sites	industrial; ranch link weak — watchlist
Temecula CA (Vail)	none	outcome-side NULL	—	87,000-ac Vail Ranch → ~60,000 homes 1985–2010 [B2]

5 · The first three correlations, examined honestly

1 — Ladera Ranch (the template). Heavy-tier quarantine county; ~21,000-head operation named in the 1911 federal circular; quantified arsenic estimates; candidate structure located in un-graded open space; diagnosis timing consistent with (not probative of) in-utero exposure during grading. Soil testing organizing with council support.

2 — Temecula / Vail Ranch (the exposure twin). An 87,000-acre operation — among California's largest, in a quarantined county — sold late 1970s, converted to ~60,000 homes. No cluster reported: a null that disciplines the method and provides a comparison community. Targeting pass v1 below; its vat sites are exactly as unrecorded as Ladera's.

3 — The Acreage, Florida (the answer-key overlay). A state-declared pediatric cluster, closed unresolved, on rapidly built-out former citrus/range land, in the one state with a vat registry — and in that state's longest-dipping county. No agency appears ever to have overlaid Florida's vat map onto its cluster investigations. Executable from public records via G11.

6 · Vail Ranch targeting pass v1



Locus logic per the Ladera method: HQ working corrals + creek water lines + rail shipping point. Positions approximate pending historic-imagery registration (1938 Riverside County flights — acquisition listed in next

phase).

7 · Next phase — recommendations

1. SEND G11 (drafted): FDEP/FDOH records request for the full ~3,400-site inventory + GIS. The Acreage overlay follows directly. Highest value, lowest cost.
2. Ladera soils execution: the council/consultant sampling plan proceeds independently (SED-01 pond core with dating; vat-candidate targets; XRF transects incl. vegetation-stress test).
3. Vail v2: register 1938 Riverside flights (UCSB FrameFinder frames) + 1901/1942 topos over the lower ranch; produce coordinate-level targets; propose to Riverside County as a pilot replication.
4. Complete the county-year quarantine table from remaining BAI annual volumes (1906–1916 downloaded/queued) — the exposure layer's backbone for all 15 states.
5. Registry-grade outcome data: CDPH request for South OC (G01) and equivalent aggregate requests in any state where Phase 1 flags a candidate.
6. Publication path: methods preprint after the Florida overlay returns — whichever way it points. The credibility of a null is the method's proof of honesty.
7. California policy ask (for Gresko): a Florida-style inventory bill. Florida's 1994 legislation is the drafted precedent; the FY1910 release ledger is the evidence California's exposure was material.

8 · Source archive (all held locally with SHA-256 manifest)

USDA BAI Circulars 174/183/207 (1911–12), 1912 proclamation, Farmers' Bulletin 1057 (1919), BAI Annual Reports FY1910–11 extracts [A1] · FDEP CDV program page, vat list (parsed CSV), 58-pp. assessment report, cleanup-sites list, voluntary-cleanup guidance [A2] · USDA NAL program history [A2] · NSW DPI dip-yards guidance [A2] · ITRC Ozark NF case study, USyd dip-site thesis [B1] · UF 2004 hidden-vats article, Type Investigations Acreage report, Georgia Health News Waycross report, Vail Ranch history, AU pesticides map [B2] · 12-file national archive: `research/national_crossreference/source_archive/` + `SHA256_MANIFEST.txt`

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